

Who to Target, and Who Signs

Two decisions, and they're different. **Which buildings** you pursue, and **which person** at those buildings you write to. Getting the second one wrong wastes a perfectly good account.

Part 1 — Which buildings

Define your own limits first

Before any list, write down:

- **Radius.** How far will you actually send a crew, nightly, in traffic?
- **Building types** you can service.
- **Size floor.** The smallest monthly contract worth a walkthrough.
- **Size ceiling.** The largest job you could staff without breaking something.
- **Capabilities you don't have.** Medical waste, high-rise glass, floor restoration, union sites.

This takes ten minutes and saves weeks. Most wasted effort in commercial cleaning comes from pursuing accounts the operator could never have serviced.

Segment priority

In rough order of return, though your market may differ.

1. Property management — most work per conversation

One relationship can expose several buildings. Win the manager, not the building.

Longer procurement and they'll want insurance, references and responsiveness in writing. Worth it: the second and third buildings come without a sales process.

2. Office and professional — the largest pool

Law firms, accountants, insurance, financial advisors, coworking. Straightforward scope, predictable frequency, and they understand recurring contracts.

Most contested. Every cleaning company calls these. Your advantage is timing, not persistence.

3. Medical and dental — highest value per square foot

Frequency can't lapse. Compliance drives the specification. They pay more and they stay longer.

Only if you're genuinely set up for it — protocols, documentation, and any waste handling the site requires. Getting in and failing here costs more than not getting in.

4. Industrial and light industrial

Larger contracts, more specialist scope, safety requirements. Good if you have the equipment.

5. Retail and everything else

Often has closing staff who already clean. Schools, childcare and gyms sit here: stable, less contested, lower value, and often seasonal. Childcare in particular cares about background checks more than price.

Part 2 — Who signs

A job title is not proof. Confirm it before you treat someone as the decision maker.

Building type	Who signs	Write to	Don't write to
Property management	Property Manager; Portfolio Manager if multi-site	The manager named on the building listing or the firm's team page	The leasing agent
Office, under ~50 staff	Office Manager	Office Manager	The managing partner
Office, over ~50	Facilities Manager	Facilities Manager	HR
Medical / dental	Practice Manager or Office Manager	Practice Manager	The physician or dentist
Industrial	Operations Manager or Plant Manager	Operations Manager	HR
School / childcare	Director, Administrator, or Business Manager	Director for a single site	Teachers
Gym / fitness	General Manager	GM	Front desk
Retail	Store Manager, only if not chain-decided	Store Manager	Corporate

The mistake that costs the most

Writing to the dentist instead of the practice manager. Medical is the highest-value segment and the one where this error is most common. The dentist is treating patients, doesn't handle vendors, and will delete it. The practice manager runs the building, holds the budget, and is the person whose week gets easier if you're good.

Same pattern elsewhere: the managing partner doesn't buy cleaning, the office manager does.

What three of them actually care about

Property Manager. Answers to building owners. Judged on tenant complaints and cost. *Worries about:* a tenant escalating over their head, a vendor who doesn't answer the phone, being blamed. *Wins with:* a written response-time commitment, and being able to cover more than one building.

Practice Manager (medical). Runs everything non-clinical. Compliance isn't optional. *Worries about:* an inspection, a patient complaining about a restroom, clinical staff doing cleaning they shouldn't. *Wins with:* documented protocols, consistent frequency, and reporting they can file.

Office Manager. Facilities is one of eight things they own. *Worries about:* chasing the cleaners, the office looking bad when clients visit. *Wins with:* one point of contact and a response time. They want it handled and invisible.

Finding the name

Cheapest first. Stop when you have it.

1. **Their website** — about, team, leadership, contact pages. Best hit rate for this segment, and free.
2. **Google review replies** — managers and owners sign them by name. Consistently overlooked.
3. **Your state's business registry** — officers and registered agents. Free, public, reliable for smaller operators.
4. **LinkedIn** — company page, then people, filtered by role.
5. **Phone the front desk** — *"Who looks after the cleaning contract there?"* Often the fastest route, and people generally just tell you.

Expect to find a name for roughly two-thirds. If you're finding one every time, you're probably recording guesses as facts.

When you only have a generic inbox

info@ isn't useless. It's useless when the email assumes it reached the owner.

Write it for the person who'll forward it: *"If this isn't your area, could you pass it to whoever looks after the cleaning contract?"* Short, no assumptions, easy to hand on.

Confirming someone actually signs

Mark them confirmed only when they've said so, or a published document says so. Until then, ask early in the conversation:

"Besides yourself, who'd be involved in deciding?"

Plain, normal, and it saves you a walkthrough for someone who can't buy.